

FINANCE 4 TEENS: COLLEGE PLANNING CHECKLIST

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. EXPLORE COLLEGES

Start researching colleges early so you can compare your options.

- ☐ Make a list of colleges that interest me.
 - ☐ Research majors and programs I am interested in.
 - ☐ Research admission requirements.
 - ☐ Compare college locations.
 - ☐ Research estimated costs of attendance.
 - ☐ Compare tuition and fees.
 - ☐ Research housing and food costs.
 - ☐ Research transportation and other expenses.
 - ☐ Attend a college tour, information session, or virtual event.
 - ☐ Write down questions I have about each college.
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2. UNDERSTAND THE COST

College costs can include more than tuition.

College I am researching:

Tuition and fees: \$ _____

Housing: \$ _____

Food: \$ _____

Books and supplies: \$ _____

Transportation: \$ _____

Other expenses: \$ _____

Estimated total cost: \$ _____

3. FINANCIAL AID

Learn about ways to reduce the amount you need to pay.

- ☐ Learn what financial aid is.
 - ☐ Learn what the FAFSA is.
 - ☐ Research grants.
 - ☐ Research scholarships.
 - ☐ Research work-study opportunities.
 - ☐ Check the financial aid requirements for colleges I am interested in.
 - ☐ Compare financial aid offers.
 - ☐ Calculate the estimated cost after grants and scholarships.
 - ☐ Research student loans if I need additional financial assistance.
 - ☐ Understand the interest rate and repayment terms before borrowing.
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4. SCHOLARSHIPS

- ☐ Make a list of scholarships I may qualify for.
- ☐ Check scholarship requirements.

- ☐ Record application deadlines.
 - ☐ Prepare a list of activities and accomplishments.
 - ☐ Ask for recommendation letters when needed.
 - ☐ Write and review scholarship essays.
 - ☐ Submit applications before their deadlines.
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5. IMPORTANT DEADLINES

College Application Deadline

Date: _____

FAFSA Deadline

Date: _____

Scholarship Deadline

Date: _____

Financial Aid Documents

Date: _____

College Decision Deadline

Date: _____

Enrollment Deadline

Date: _____

6. COMPARE COLLEGES

COLLEGE A

College Name: _____

Estimated Total Cost: \$ _____

Scholarships/Grants: \$ _____

Estimated Cost After Aid: \$ _____

Amount I May Need to Borrow: \$ _____

COLLEGE B

College Name: _____

Estimated Total Cost: \$ _____

Scholarships/Grants: \$ _____

Estimated Cost After Aid: \$ _____

Amount I May Need to Borrow: \$ _____

COLLEGE C

College Name: _____

Estimated Total Cost: \$ _____

Scholarships/Grants: \$ _____

Estimated Cost After Aid: \$ _____

Amount I May Need to Borrow: \$ _____

7. MY COLLEGE FINANCIAL PLAN

Which college is currently my top choice?

Why?

How do I plan to pay for college?

- ☐ Savings
- ☐ Scholarships
- ☐ Grants
- ☐ Family contributions
- ☐ Work-study
- ☐ Student loans
- ☐ Other: _____

What is one financial question I still need to research?

REFLECTION

What surprised me about the cost of college?

What is one thing I can do now to prepare financially for college?

What is one thing I want to learn more about before making college decisions?

Finance 4 Teens

Girl Scout Gold Award Project